



full agenda

apaa patent surgery course 2026

3-6 november 2026 / the landmark bangkok

four tutors

Senior patent practitioners from Hong Kong, Australia and Japan.

eight topics

From the parts of a specification to freedom to operate and the use of AI.

taught in english

Three and a half days of drafting, marked by the tutors.

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day 1 / tuesday

3 November 2026

09:30-16:00

09:30-10:00 **Welcome and inauguration**

10:00-10:30 **Course introduction**

10:30-11:30 **TOPIC 1**
Typical parts of the patent application

The detailed description, drawings, background, abstract and summary, and how each of those sections supports the claims.

TUTOR **Ben Fitzpatrick**

11:30-11:45 **Morning tea**

11:45-12:30 **TOPIC 2**
How to properly construe a patent

The fundamental rules of construction, including purposive construction, followed by practical examples of how these principles are applied. The role of expert evidence in construction.

TUTOR **Ben Fitzpatrick**

12:30-13:30 **Lunch**

13:30-16:00 **TOPIC 3**
Patent claim drafting exercise

Participants draft claims to a patent specification in group exercises, assessed by the tutors. Each claim is checked to ensure it captures competing products, avoids unnecessary limitations, relates its elements to each other, overcomes the prior art and is industrially applicable. Particular focus on support and sufficiency, and the balance between broad claim scope and these internal requirements.

TUTORS **Steven Fung, Ben Fitzpatrick, Greg Munt, Shigeru Inaba**

16:00 **Recap of day one and outline of day two**

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day 2 / wednesday

4 November 2026

09:30-16:00

09:30-11:00 TOPIC 3 CONTINUED
Patent claim drafting exercises
 Participants draft a set of claims in groups, which the tutors then review individually.

11:00-11:15 Tea break

11:15-12:30 TOPIC 3 CONTINUED
Drafting exercise
 Groups continue the practical exercise, and each group presents its answer to the class.

12:30-13:30 Lunch

13:30-16:00 TOPIC 4
The use of AI in drafting specifications
 Appropriate ways to use AI to assist in drafting specifications.
 TUTOR **Steven Fung**

16:00 Recap of day two and outline of day three

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day 3 / thursday

5 November 2026

09:30-16:00

09:30-11:00 TOPIC 5
Drafting techniques for global prosecution strategy
 The specific requirements of particular jurisdictions, such as the EPO and the USPTO, and drafting strategies to address them.
 TUTORS **Greg Munt, Steven Fung, Shigeru Inaba**

11:00-11:15 Tea break

11:15-12:30 TOPIC 6
Dealing with complex office actions
 Responding to complex office actions, including amending claims and developing arguments, with practical exercises.
 TUTORS **Ben Fitzpatrick, Steven Fung, Greg Munt, Shigeru Inaba**

12:30-13:30 Lunch

13:30-16:00 TOPIC 7
How to advise on freedom to operate
 How to structure the advice, including its necessary qualifications and limitations. Infringement and invalidity considerations. A worked practical example of a freedom-to-operate advice is provided.
 TUTOR **Ben Fitzpatrick**

16:00 Recap of day three and outline of day four

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day 4 / friday

6 November 2026

09:00-16:30

09:00-11:00

TOPIC 8

AI in office actions and prior art analysis

A continuation of Topic 4: handling an office action with AI, and analysing prior art documents with AI.

TUTOR **Steven Fung**

11:00-11:15

Morning tea

11:15-12:30

TOPIC 8 CONTINUED

AI in office actions and prior art analysis

TUTOR **Steven Fung**

12:30-13:30

Lunch

13:30-15:30

TRADEMARK CARAVAN

Non-Traditional Marks: From Practice to Challenges

A presentation and panel discussion. Onsite access is complimentary for course registrants, with no separate registration needed.

TUTOR **Ben Fitzpatrick**

15:30-16:30

Presentation of completion certificates

your tutors

**Steven Fung**

HONG KONG

**Ben Fitzpatrick**

AUSTRALIA

**Shigeru Inaba**

JAPAN

**Greg Munt**

AUSTRALIA